

THE B.L.U.E. METHOD™

8 Signs Your Nervous System Is Running the Show

A free guide from Susan Blue & Dee Kinsey

*We are not broken. We are patterned.
And patterns can change.*

You picked this up for a reason.

Maybe something in the title landed. Maybe you've been trying to explain something to yourself for a long time and haven't quite had the words. Maybe you just felt something shift when you read the signs.

That response — that small recognition — is information. Not a diagnosis. Not a verdict. Information. Your body already knows something about this. This guide is an invitation to get curious about what it knows.

This is not a guide about what's wrong with you. There is nothing wrong with you.

The signs in this guide are not symptoms of dysfunction. They are signs of a nervous system that learned — usually a long time ago, often without your conscious participation — to respond in certain ways in order to keep you safe. Those responses made sense when they formed. They are intelligent. Automatic. And they can run long past the point where they're still useful.

What changes them isn't more insight. It isn't trying harder. It isn't understanding your childhood better. It's working at the level where the patterns actually live: the body.

Read through at whatever pace feels right. You don't need to read the signs in order. You don't need to resonate with all of them. If even one of them touches something real for you — if you feel even a small shift in your breath, a flicker of recognition, a subtle sense of 'yes, that' — that's enough. That's the beginning.

If you felt even a small response to that — a little bit of relief, a change in your breath — that's what truth feels like.

— Dee Kinsey

With care,

Susan Blue & Dee Kinsey

www.somaticeducationforselfhealing.com

How to use this guide

Each sign includes two things: an explanation and a pair of reflection questions.

The explanation is there to give context — a nervous system framework for what you might be experiencing. Not to analyze yourself with. Not to build another story. Just to orient.

The reflection questions are not journaling prompts in the traditional sense. They're invitations to notice — in your body, not your head. Before you answer with words, see if you can feel into the question. Where does it land? What shifts when you hold it?

A few things to keep in mind as you read:

- Go slowly. This isn't a mental exercise. You don't need to get through all eight signs in one sitting.
- You don't have to resonate with all of them. One sign that lands is more useful than eight signs processed quickly.
- If something activates you as you read — if you feel tension, heat, a tightening, a pulling away — that's information. Stay with it if you can. Or put the guide down and come back.
- There are no right answers to the reflection questions. There's only what's true for you right now.

A quick grounding before you begin:

Before you read on, take a breath. Not a performed breath — just a natural one. Notice where you feel it. Notice where you are in your body right now. You don't have to change anything about it. Just notice.

That's it. That's the practice.

8 Signs Your Nervous System Is Running the Show

Read each one slowly. Let it land before you move on.

1

I overreact — and I know it — but I can't stop it in the moment.

This is one of the clearest signs that your nervous system is running an older response, not responding to what's actually happening right now. You can see yourself doing it. You might even narrate it in real time. And still — the reaction comes anyway, bigger than the moment seems to call for. That gap between what you know and what your body does isn't a character flaw. It's the difference between insight and a patterned nervous system response. Knowing is cortical. Reacting is subcortical. They live in different places — and knowing rarely wins when the body has already mobilized.

Pause here.

→ *Where in your body do you first feel the reaction beginning — before it becomes words or behavior?*

→ *What would it be like to notice that sensation without immediately acting on it?*

2

I'm exhausted in a way that sleep doesn't fix.

There's tired from doing too much. And then there's this — the bone-deep, persistent depletion that doesn't lift after rest, after a weekend, after a vacation. You wake up tired. You feel like you've been running a race nobody else can see. When the nervous system stays in a chronic state of low-level activation — not full-blown stress, just always slightly on — the body spends enormous energy simply maintaining that readiness. Nothing gets stored. Nothing fully repairs. Sleep happens, but the system doesn't actually downregulate enough to restore. This kind of exhaustion lives in the body, not in your schedule.

Pause here.

→ *Does your exhaustion have a quality to it — more like heaviness, flatness, tension, or something else?*

→ *Can you remember a time when you felt genuinely rested? What was different then?*

3

When things get heavy, I go somewhere else — numb, checked out, scrolling, flat.

Checking out isn't weakness. It's a survival response — specifically, one end of the freeze spectrum. When activation reaches a threshold the system registers as too much, the nervous system pulls back from it. Numbing, dissociation, zoning out, compulsive scrolling, the flat affect that makes people ask if you're okay — these are all versions of the same protective withdrawal. The problem isn't that it happens. It's that it happens automatically, before you've made a conscious choice about it. And when you come back, the thing that triggered it is still there — plus now you've lost time.

Pause here.

- *What tends to trigger the checked-out feeling for you — certain people, topics, levels of noise or demand?*
- *What does it feel like in your body just before you disconnect — if you can catch it that early?*

4

I understand exactly why I do this — and I still do it anyway.

This one that stops people cold, because it feels like it should be the solution. If I understand it well enough, I'll stop doing it. But understanding lives in the thinking brain. Patterns live in the body — in the nervous system, in the cells, in the automatic responses that fire before conscious thought has a chance to weigh in. Insight is not the problem. Most people who find their way to this work are highly self-aware. The gap isn't in their understanding — it's in the fact that understanding alone doesn't change what the body keeps doing. The pattern has to be met at the level where it actually lives.

Pause here.

- *Which pattern do you understand most clearly — and still find yourself caught in?*
- *If understanding it isn't enough, what do you imagine would need to be different?*

5

I feel everything for everyone — but I don't know what I actually feel.

High sensitivity to other people's emotional states is often framed as a gift — and it is one. It's also, for many people, a survival strategy that got wired before they had words for it. If the emotional climate around you determined whether you were safe, learning to read it with precision was adaptive. Necessary. The cost is that your own interior becomes hard to locate. You can map everyone else's experience with extraordinary accuracy. But what do you feel? What do you need? What's actually true for you right now — not in response to someone else, just on your own? That channel often goes quiet. Developing a relationship with your own felt sense is part of what this work is for.

Pause here.

- *When you check in with yourself right now — not what you think you should feel, what do you actually notice?*
- *What's the difference between feeling something for yourself versus feeling something for someone else?*

6

My mind won't stop spinning.

The looping thoughts, the rehearsing of conversations, the catastrophizing, the going-over-it-again-even-though-you-already-went-over-it — this isn't a thinking problem. It's a nervous system problem that shows up in thinking. When the body holds unresolved activation — energy that was mobilized for a response that never fully completed — the thinking mind keeps searching for a solution. It's trying to resolve something cognitively that isn't located there. The spinning isn't the cause. It's the signal. The body is trying to discharge something it hasn't been able to complete.

Pause here.

- *When your mind is spinning, does it tend to loop around a particular theme — worry, planning, replaying, rehearsing?*
- *What happens in your body when the spinning starts — tightness, restlessness, shallow breath?*

7

I can't get a handle on my health or my pain.

The nervous system and the body's physical systems are not separate. Chronic activation affects immune function, inflammatory response, digestion, sleep architecture, hormonal regulation, and pain perception — among many other things. When the system is persistently dysregulated, the body keeps score in physical ways. This doesn't mean your pain is imaginary or that your health conditions aren't real. It means the nervous system context in which your body is operating matters — a great deal — to how those conditions present and how available your body is to heal. Working at the level of the nervous system isn't a replacement for medical care. It's something that can change the conditions under which that care works.

Pause here.

- *Is there a connection between your stress levels or emotional state and how your physical symptoms show up?*
- *What would it mean to you if the nervous system were part of what's driving what you're experiencing physically?*

8

I feel like I'm going through the motions.

This one is quieter than the others, and sometimes harder to name. It's not crisis. It's not dramatic. It's just... flat. You're doing the things. Life looks fine from the outside. But something that should feel like yours doesn't, quite. You're present in form but not fully arrived. This is often what the later stages of chronic stress or shutdown look like — not breakdown, but disconnection. The nervous system has adapted to a long-term load by dampening responsiveness. Color goes out of things. Meaning becomes harder to access. The body is protecting you from a level of experience it has decided is too much to feel fully. Coming back to yourself — not performing, not managing, actually inhabiting your own life — is possible. It requires working at the level where the dampening happens.

Pause here.

- *Is there something you used to feel more fully — connection, joy, curiosity, aliveness — that feels further away now?*
- *What does 'going through the motions' feel like in your body when you notice it?*

If any of these landed for you —

It doesn't mean something is wrong with you. It means your nervous system is doing what nervous systems do: running the patterns it learned, in the body it has.

Patterns are not identity. They are not destiny. They are stored responses — intelligent, automatic, and changeable when met at the level where they actually live.

The place they live is not in your thinking. It's in your body.

The B.L.U.E. Method™ was built for exactly this — for people who understand themselves and still can't seem to change. For people who have done the work and know something is still missing. For people who are ready to stop working on themselves from the outside and go to the level where the pattern actually lives.

We are not broken. We are patterned. And patterns can change

— The B.L.U.E. Method™

YOUR NEXT STEP

Is Your Nervous System Running the Show?

If this guide resonated, the next step is Is Your Nervous System Running the Show? — a three-module mini-course (\$27) that takes you deeper into the nervous system, how patterns get wired, and how you can begin to work with them.

Module 1: The System Running the Show — what your nervous system is actually doing and why

Module 2: How Patterns Get Wired — where they came from and why they keep running

Module 3: You Can Influence This — how to begin working at the level where patterns live

Go slowly. This isn't a mental exercise. It's a 'can I feel within my body what's going on?' That's where it starts.

Is Your Nervous System Running the Show?

3 modules · Self-paced · \$27

<https://app.podia.com/products/is-your-nervous-system-running-the-show>

The B.L.U.E. Method™ is a somatic nervous system framework developed by Susan Blue and Dee Kinsey. It is built on two lived healing journeys and one shared understanding: that the nervous system — not the thinking mind — is where patterns are stored, and where they have to be met if they're going to shift.

The four movements of the method — Breathe & Befriend, Listen, Locate & Land, Unwind & Unravel, Express & Integrate — are not a protocol. They are invitations. Each one asks the body a question the mind can't answer for it.

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